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Daily reports · 28 October 2026

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1. The day at a glance

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Anxious Public attention split between the high-profile Iraqi PM visit to Damascus (widely welcomed but mocked by some over donations amid poverty), continued anger over Jordan's deadly strikes on Daraa, Israeli incursions in Quneitra, and severe flooding disrupting Raqqa, Hasakah and Deir ez-Zor. Kurdish and Turkish-language commenters are sharply divided over SDF integration with Damascus, with many blaming it for attacks on Kurds. Outlets largely stress diplomacy and reconstruction, while ordinary commenters focus on economic hardship, security incidents and distrust of official narratives.

2. What people said

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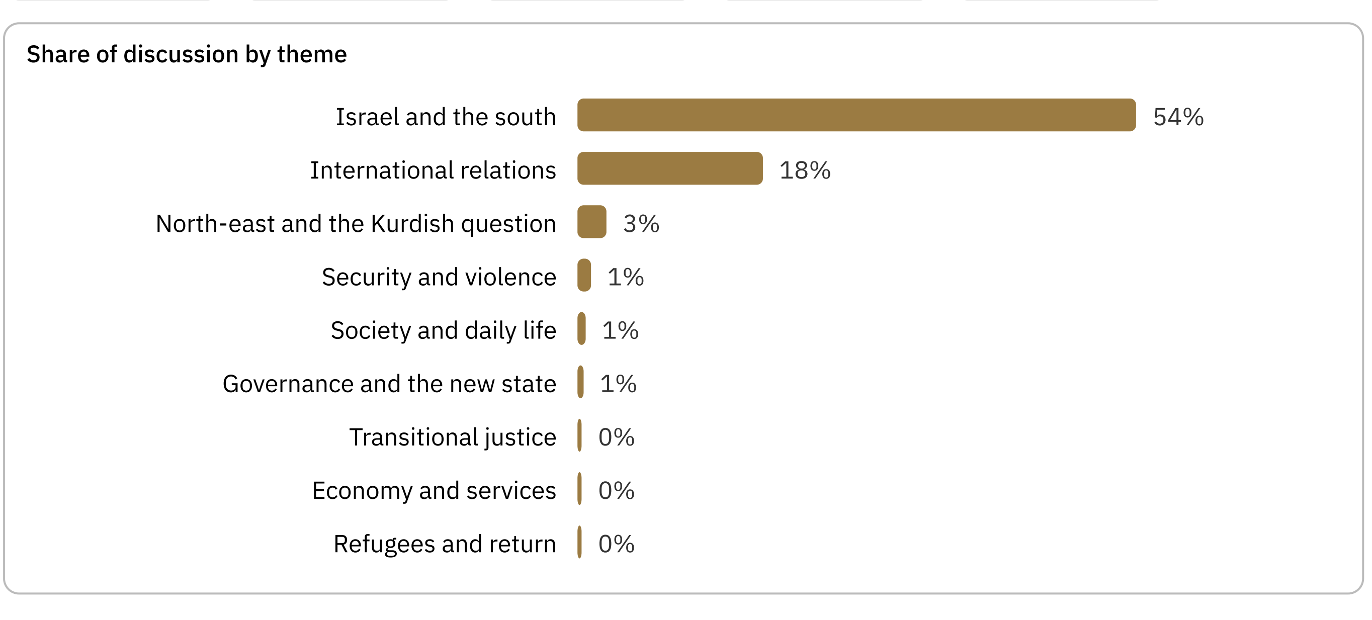
The day in numbers

Leaning negative	Mostly neutral	19	4,017	5
People's tone	Outlets' tone	stories followed	post analyses	updates

Share of discussion by theme



The day's stories

1. **Fallout from Jordanian airstrikes on Daraa continues** International relations · People: strongly negative · Outlets: leaning negative · 78% of the discussion
   After Jordanian airstrikes on Daraa and Suwayda countryside killed civilians including children, Syria's Foreign Ministry summoned Jordan's ambassador Sufyan al-Qudah and handed a protest note. Damascus and Amman agreed to a joint security committee; the Nassib border crossing, closed briefly, reopened.
2. **Iraqi PM Ali al-Zaidi makes historic first visit to Damascus** International relations · People: mostly neutral · Outlets: leaning positive · 21% of the discussion
   Iraqi Prime Minister Ali al-Zaidi visited Damascus on 28 October 2026, meeting President Ahmad al-Sharaa to discuss oil exports via the Baniyas pipeline, trade, border security and reconstruction. He also visited the Umayyad Mosque and Sayyida Zaynab shrine, donating $10 million. It is the first such visit since Assad's fall.
3. **Al-Sharaa's extended Dijlah TV interview ahead of Iraqi PM's Damascus visit** International relations · People: mostly neutral · Outlets: leaning positive · 11% of the discussion
   President Ahmad al-Sharaa gave a lengthy interview to Iraq's Dijlah TV covering Syria-Iraq oil, trade and water cooperation, detained Syrians in Iraq, the Sayyida Zaynab shrine, and diminished ISIS threats, ahead of Iraqi PM Ali al-Zaidi's first official visit to Damascus since Assad's fall. Official media amplified the interview extensively; outlets noted agreements on the Haditha-Baniyas oil pipeline.
4. **Turkish and Kurdish-language backlash over SDF integration with Damascus** North-east and the Kurdish question · People: strongly negative · Outlets: leaning negative · 9% of the discussion
   A wave of Turkish and Kurdish-language YouTube comments reacted angrily to reported attacks on Kurds in Rojava, blaming the SDF/PKK leadership's integration deal with Damascus for leaving Kurdish communities undefended. Commenters also referenced attacks on returnees in Tal Abyad and property disputes in Kobani and Qamishli.
5. **Heavy rains and flash floods hit Raqqa, Hasakah, Deir ez-Zor** Society and daily life · People: mostly neutral · Outlets: mostly neutral · 4% of the discussion
   Severe thunderstorms and flash floods struck Raqqa, Hasakah, Deir ez-Zor and parts of Homs, Hama and Aleppo countryside on 28 October, cutting roads and power, forcing school closures in Raqqa, and halting floating bridges in Deir ez-Zor and Mayadin. Civil Defense teams were mobilized across affected areas.
6. **Clash near French Camp in Idlib kills French foreign fighter** Security and violence · Outlets: leaning negative · 2% of the discussion
   Internal Security forces in Idlib clashed with an armed group that left the so-called 'French Camp' near Harim, violating an agreement not to carry weapons outside it. A French national was killed and a Syrian civilian wounded; the group reportedly vowed revenge.
7. **Syrians react to tight Israeli election results** International relations · Outlets: mostly neutral · 2% of the discussion
   Partial results from Israel's Knesset election showed Netanyahu's bloc and Eisenkot's camp in a tight race, with Arab parties securing a notable share of seats. Syrian outlets and public commenters followed the results closely, largely from the angle of how outcomes might affect Israeli policy toward Syria.
8. **Security forces announce drug and arms trafficking busts in Homs and Deir ez-Zor** Security and violence · Outlets: leaning positive · 2% of the discussion
   Syria's Anti-Narcotics Department dismantled a network in Homs smuggling 200,000 Captagon pills from Lebanon, while Internal Security forces in Deir ez-Zor arrested eight people and seized weapons and drugs near Albu Kamal. Authorities report roughly 3 million Captagon pills seized nationwide in October 2026.
9. **Attacks on Kurdish returnee families in Tal Abyad continue** North-east and the Kurdish question · Outlets: leaning negative · 2% of the discussion
   Kurdish outlets and activists report continued attacks on displaced Kurdish families returning to Tal Abyad (Girê Spî), drawing condemnation from a Qamishli civic initiative and the US State Department, which urged Damascus to ensure accountability and safe returns.
10. **Israeli incursions and shelling continue in Quneitra** Israel and the south · People: leaning negative · Outlets: leaning negative · 2% of the discussion
    Israeli forces shelled farmland near Saida al-Jolan in southern Quneitra countryside on 28 October, after earlier detaining and releasing a young man during an incursion into Abu Mathra village. North Press and Qatar News Agency also reported separate incursions and a temporary checkpoint near Majdoliya.
11. **Transitional justice court sentences former security officer** Transitional justice · Outlets: leaning positive · 1% of the discussion
    Syria's Fourth Criminal Court in Damascus sentenced Mohammed Islam Arnawouti, a former Assad-era political security volunteer, to 15 years for arbitrarily detaining civilians without warrants. The ruling, covered by official and independent outlets, is part of around 61 cases the court is examining under the new transitional justice process, with the Justice Ministry stressing judicial reform.
12. **University mergers and school curriculum controversies continue** North-east and the Kurdish question · People: leaning negative · Outlets: leaning negative · 1% of the discussion
    Syria's Higher Education Council ordered Rojava University merged with Euphrates University and Kobani University with Aleppo University, provoking student protests and rejection by Kurdish institutions. Separately, feminist group Femena criticized newly revised Syrian textbooks for removing images of women and lessons on citizenship.
13. **Electricity company explains worsening power rationing** Economy and services · Outlets: mostly neutral · 1% of the discussion
    The Syrian Electricity Company said increased rationing hours stem from maintenance work, generation units at Tishreen plant remaining offline, and a shortage of Azerbaijani gas supplies needed to run power stations. The explanation was widely circulated by independent outlets.
14. **SalamAir launches first Oman-Damascus flights** Economy and services · Outlets: leaning positive · 1% of the discussion
    Oman's SalamAir began operating flights between Muscat and Damascus on 28 October, with two flights weekly, following a technical inspection of Damascus airport in late September. Syria's civil aviation authority head confirmed the agreement with the airline.
15. **Assassinations and unresolved violence in Deir ez-Zor and Hama countryside** Security and violence · Outlets: leaning negative · 1% of the discussion
    Separate violent incidents were reported in eastern and central Syria: an interior ministry member was shot dead by unknown gunmen in Deir ez-Zor, an armed robbery attempt in Hama countryside left one man seriously wounded, a drive-by killing near Qara in rural Damascus, and an old blood-feud killing in a village near Qamishli.
16. **Landmine explosion kills three civilians in Hasakah countryside** Security and violence · Outlets: leaning negative · 0% of the discussion
    A landmine left over from war exploded in Umm Zar village, Shaddadi area, southern Hasakah countryside, on 27 October, killing three people and injuring two children. North Press and Enab Baladi reported the incident, highlighting the ongoing danger of war remnants in the north-east.
17. **Displaced families return from Jarabulus camps under 'Syria Without Camps' plan** Refugees and return · Outlets: leaning positive · 0% of the discussion
    A convoy of 111 displaced families left Jarabulus's Bunyan 2 and Yousef Beik camps on 27 October, heading to original areas in Aleppo, Idlib, Hama, Homs and Deir ez-Zor provinces. Aleppo's social affairs directorate said the move implements Decree 59 and the 'Syria Without Camps' vision.
18. **Arrests made in killing of driver Qais Sanufa near Damascus** Security and violence · Outlets: leaning negative · 0% of the discussion
    Internal Security forces in Qudsaya, rural Damascus, arrested four suspects accused of killing driver Qais Sanufa after luring him under pretext of robbery; his body was found in Wadi Basima the day after he disappeared. Investigations pinpointed an abandoned farm as the crime scene.
19. **Israeli incursions and detentions continue in Quneitra** Israel and the south · Outlets: leaning negative · 0% of the discussion
    Israeli occupation forces conducted a ground incursion with military vehicles into the village of al-Mu'allaqa in Quneitra countryside, searching homes and detaining at least one person, while separately Israel arrested three young men in rural Quneitra. Levant24's tracker also logged continued Israeli strikes, checkpoints and property destruction across Syria.

3. What the media said

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Jordan border reopens, Iraq's PM makes historic Damascus visit

In short: The media's dominant story was the aftermath of Jordan's deadly strikes on Daraa, with the reopening of the Nasib crossing and a joint Syrian-Jordanian investigative committee, alongside the first visit by an Iraqi prime minister to Damascus since Assad's fall. Coverage of the Daraa strikes ranged from Jordanian sources blaming a security vacuum to Syrian outlets questioning coordination and highlighting civilian deaths, while the Iraq visit drew extensive attention to oil, trade and security cooperation. Economic coverage focused on currency instability and Syria's $22 billion debt burden even as officials touted banking sector revival.

Security

The media gave heavy coverage to the fallout from Jordan's strikes on Daraa that killed civilians, with Asharq Al-Awsat reporting Syria held funerals for victims while Jordan expressed regret, and Al Jazeera, Qatar-funded, reporting the border reopened amid a probe. A joint Syrian-Jordanian security committee was formed, according to The National, The Jerusalem Post and Anadolu Agency, Turkish state-run, to investigate the strikes, with Enab Baladi, an independent Syrian outlet, and Hawar News, affiliated with the Kurdish-led administration, confirming the committee's formation. The pro-Israel Foundation for Defense of Democracies argued the strikes exposed a security vacuum in southern Syria, while a Jordanian source cited by Asharq Al-Awsat said areas outside government control there are a haven for terrorists and drug traffickers; by contrast, Zaman al-Wasl, independent, reported that Jordanian journalists and their government failed to provide evidence of the alleged terrorists, and Syria TV, independent, questioned who identified the targets. Separately, Syria TV and Zaman al-Wasl reported continued Israeli incursions into Quneitra, including an abduction and new checkpoint, while Xinhua reported Israeli bulldozing destroyed olive groves in southern Syria. Enab Baladi and The Syrian Observer reported a French fighter killed in clashes with Syrian security forces in Idlib, and Anadolu Agency reported two Defense Ministry personnel killed by unidentified gunmen in Idlib.

Economy

Economic coverage centred on the Nasib border crossing's reopening, reported by Syria TV, independent, and Al-Quds Al-Arabi, after its closure following the strikes. Al-Watan Online, independent, cited an expert saying the dollar trading at 20,000 in merchants' books reflects an unclear monetary policy entrenching a cash market, while Enab Baladi reported Syria remains burdened with debts from the previous era exceeding 22 billion dollars. L'Orient-Le Jour similarly reported the Syrian pound under pressure with dollars kept out of banks. Against this, Syria TV examined whether Syria's banking sector is reviving amid moves toward Visa and Mastercard access and a $100 million initiative, and Hawar News, affiliated with the Kurdish-led administration, reported that lack of support and rising prices are pushing Jazira farmers to cut cultivated areas. The Iraqi PM's visit also carried economic weight, with The New Region and Shafaq News reporting discussion of oil exports through Baniyas, and L'Orient-Le Jour noting economic matters dominated the visit.

Governance

Iraqi PM Ali al-Zaidi's first visit to Damascus since Assad's fall dominated governance coverage, with The National and TRT World, Turkish state-linked, calling it a high-profile first trip, and Syria TV, independent, and Al-Watan Online reporting his meeting with President al-Sharaa. Al-Modon and Enab Baladi reported economic cooperation and oil, water and security ties as priorities, while Al Akhbar offered a more skeptical analysis describing the cooperation as

How they compare

Ordinary Syrians' reactions to the Daraa strikes were far angrier than the media's measured diplomatic framing, with posts reaching up to 91% of discussion and sharply negative tone, including widespread mockery of Jordanian officials and accusations of collusion with Israel, a framing the media largely avoided. The Iraqi PM's visit drew milder, mixed public reaction (up to 22% of posts, mildly positive), with some welcoming it and others criticizing a reported donation to religious sites as out of touch given poverty, a detail absent from the media coverage reviewed. Syrians also discussed topics barely touched by the media sampled here: angry Turkish and Kurdish-language backlash over the SDF's integration deal with Damascus and attacks on Kurdish returnees in Tal Abyad, controversy over university mergers affecting Kurdish institutions, reactions to Israel's tight election, and flash floods in Raqqa, Hasakah and Deir ez-Zor.

→ Full page with sources

4. Sources and method

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Reports and articles drawn on (37)

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- Syria TV: من الفيزا وماستركارد إلى 100 مليون دولار.. هل يستيقظ القطاع المصرفي السوري؟
- Hawar News: غياب الدعم وارتفاع الأسعار يدفعان مزارعي الجزيرة إلى تقليص زراعاتهم
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Written automatically by an AI model from the titles and short summaries of the reports, which are linked. It describes what the sources say, not what is true. From Syrian outlets only investigations, in-depth reports, analysis and official statements are used, and paywalled outlets are missing: this is not the whole picture.

Analysis generated automatically by an AI model from public posts. It describes what is being said, not what is true. Individuals are never named, quoted or linked.

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